

Karthik P

Cybersecurity Researcher | Penetration Tester

Malappuram, Kerala, India

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Professional Summary

Cybersecurity Researcher and Penetration Tester with hands-on expertise in network security, Active Directory exploitation, web application security, and vulnerability assessment. Skilled in red team techniques, CTF machine development, and building vulnerable lab environments for security research and training. Seeking an entry-level cybersecurity position to apply technical knowledge in real-world environments.

Technical Skills

- **Penetration Testing:** Network Pentesting, Web Application Pentesting, Active Directory
- **Web Application Security:** OWASP Top 10, SQL Injection, XSS, CSRF, SSRF, IDOR, SSTI,
- **Active Directory:** Kerberoasting, AS-REP Roasting, Pass-the-Hash, GPO Abuse, Ticket Attacks
- **Programming & Scripting:** Python, Bash

Tools

- | | | | |
|--------------|-----------|------------|------------|
| • Nmap | • Hashcat | • Nuclei | • Mimikatz |
| • Metasploit | • Hydra | • Nessus | • Gobuster |
| • Burp Suite | • SQLMap | • Impacket | • FFUF |
| • Wireshark | • Nikto | • Kerbrute | • LinPEAS |

Professional Experience

Cybersecurity Researcher & R&D Member

July 2025 – Present

Offenso Hackers Academy

- Worked as part of a cybersecurity research and development team.
- Designed and developed custom CTF machines and vulnerable lab environments for hands-on offensive security training.
- Built internal security tools and automation scripts to streamline penetration testing workflows.

Mastercard Cybersecurity virtual experience program

May 20, 2026

Forage

- Completed a job simulation where i served as an analyst on Mastercard's Security Awareness Team.
- Analyzed and identified which areas of the business needed more robust security training and implemented training courses and procedures.

VAPT Intern

June - July 2026

Hackware Security Solutions

- Gained hands-on experience performing vulnerability assessment and penetration testing across web, network, and mobile platforms
- Conducted Active Directory penetration testing and developed detailed vapt reports of vulnerabilities.

Projects

Custom Vulnerable Machines and CTF Challenges – ctf-r3dex.vercel.app

- Designed and deployed custom CTF challenges and vulnerable machines simulating real-world attack scenarios across web exploitation, privilege escalation, and network-based attack vectors.
- Implemented vulnerable web environments to demonstrate chained OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities.
- Documented challenge walkthroughs and attack paths for learning and reinforce pentesting methodologies.

lxd2root – github.com/karthikparambil/lxd2root

- Developed a privilege escalation exploit targeting LXD group misconfiguration on Linux systems, demonstrating container escape techniques to achieve root access from a low-privileged user.

Education

Bachelor of Computer Science (BCA)

2026 – Present

Yenepoya University

Advanced Diploma in Information Security(ADIS)

2025 – 2026

Offenso Hackers Academy, Calicut

Certifications

- CompTIA Pentest+ (pursuing)
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
- Advanced Diploma in Information Security (ADIS)
- Certified Cybersecurity Educator Professional (CCEP)